

SUSAN GADEGONE

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SUMMARY

Product person with five years of trauma-informed care behind me. I build wellness apps and read AI products the way someone who has sat with people in crisis reads risk: what could go wrong, and who it could hurt. Trust, safety, and privacy aren't a separate skill set for me. They're the instinct behind every product decision I make.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Product Builder, Wellness Apps

2023 – Present

- Built three wellness apps solo, including Cozy (a chore app), Roam (a Bay Area wellness resource directory), and a calendar-based mood tracker, using SwiftUI, Supabase, and AI-assisted development tools
- Ran user research and interviews for each app, then reworked features based on what people actually did, not what they said they'd do
- Won the 2024 Neolth Innovation Challenge, 1st of 11 teams, for a mental health product concept
- Selected for the Stanford AI for Good cohort, chosen from 230 applicants down to 30; project reached the top 8 to pitch investors

Lead Peer Mentor, Youth and Family Trauma-Informed Care

2019 – 2023

- Led trauma-informed care plans for youth and families, working across a team of 10+ including clinicians, case managers, and support staff, and trained new hires as they came on
- Worked the main floor of a youth drop-in center in San Francisco: homework help, food, hygiene support, daily safety and crisis calls
- Worked with roughly 300 youth over five years
- Built a pandemic-era outreach program that grew participant count 200%, and started the center's first Instagram in 2022, now around 550 followers

Writing & Research

2015 – Present

- Write about digital health and AI product design on Substack (Suzan's Product Club)
- In development: Shipped Anyway, a podcast and YouTube channel on product and mental health

EDUCATION

BA, Psychology, Arizona State University

SKILLS

Product: User research, wireframing, roadmapping, data analysis, PRDs, agile, product lifecycle management

Tools: Figma, Notion, Airtable, some SQL, AI-assisted development (Claude, Claude Code)

Domain: Digital health & wellness, trust & safety, privacy & consent design, trauma-informed design, crisis escalation, behavioral health